

Google Buzzed

10 Nations, including France and Germany have voiced privacy concerns over Google's services, particularly focused around Buzz

Bluetooth 4.0

The next generation of the standard will focus on low power consumption, according to the Bluetooth special interest group

Changing with times

We spoke to two industry personnel on the latest in technology they are implementing in their recently launched products

Fujifilm India

A Rajkumar, Country General Manager (DSC), Fujifilm India, spoke to us during the grand unveiling of 14 next-generation digital cameras at the summer 2010 carnival.

What is the technology behind CCD and BSI CMOS and how does it impact the performance of an image sensor?

Between CCD or BSI CMOS, each technology has its own advantage and disadvantage. CCD as a technology, for example, is invented in an old environment, so we had to bridge the technology by removing the hurdle. So, we need to go for hybrid technologies that really enhance their powers, which is why we prefer CMOS as a very good upgrade. When we had to shift from CCD to CMOS, there was once again a compromise that had to be made. That is why we opted for CMOS, which gives complete freedom for high-end cameras to deliver both quality and enhanced features.

How does a higher resolution camera (10 mega pixel) with lower ISO sensitivity (ISO 1600) fare against a lower resolution camera (5 mega pixel) with very high ISO sensitivity (ISO 12,800) in terms of image clarity and focus?

It is like fitting a Ferrari engine into an old ambassador. So, if at all you are talking about a digital camera, all the specifications have to be optimised to deliver a good picture quality. A higher mega pixel camera, you get a good picture. It needs to be optimized. Even on an 8 mega pixel camera, you need to put the right amount of wide dynamic range and the right amount

of ISO speed. So, that is where we have come up with a technology called EXR technology. It is nothing but an optimization of resolution, wide dynamic range and sensitivity. So, to answer your question it is not just the mega pixel or sensitivity we have to consider.

Whenever you are looking at the subject matter to shoot, if you raise the resolution alone, then you may start getting grains and even getting dots. But,



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when you start increasing only the wide dynamic range, you will be able to capture different colours or different gamuts of colours. Since the resolution is not enough, that is where I said, in order to optimize you need to have all the three set at certain levels at any given shooting environment. If we don't do that, it is not that always higher resolution can give better picture, it is not that only wide dynamic range alone can give better

picture and it is completely dependable on the shooting subject. So, this is where to provide more fidelity and power to the camera, the EXR technology helps the users to get beautiful pictures. So, there are models where we have integrated the EXR technology in our modern cameras.

What is the technology behind pet detection and how does it work, assuming humans are playing with their pets and we need to capture only the images of pet animals?

See, what happens is that as far as the detection is concerned, all subjects in range are given the priority to focus. Otherwise generally what happens is only when pets are taken into focusing and the pets might go out of focus. This feature allows each and every subject matter available in that frame to be focused well.

How do you differentiate AV and AX series as against JV, JX and JZ series in terms of market targeting or target consumer base? In other words, how do they differ in terms of price to performance or price to features factor?

The first and foremost difference between A and J series is that the A series comes under the AA category and J series in the Li-ion battery category. Otherwise when it comes to technology wise there is not much difference, if you look at the features or specifications it is almost the same. But, when it comes to AA category, it is slightly thicker and when it comes to J series it is slightly sleeker because it is Li-ion category. Price point as far as the AA battery category is concerned, it starts from Rs. 4,999, and for Li-ion category it starts from almost Rs. 6,999.

What is your goal for 2010 in terms of target audience while unveiling a broad range of digital cameras that are targeted across diverse market sectors?

We are targeting around 8 per cent of total digital camera market size in India. That is our goal. We started two years back and first year of operations has fetched us 2 per cent market share and this year we are looking to consolidate on it.

AMD India

These views were shared with Digit when we interviewed Vamsi Krishna, Senior Technical Manager of AMD India, at the India launch of the Opteron 6000 Series platform in New Delhi.

Any reactions to NVIDIA's Fermi launch and benchmark results?

The reactions came from the media. Benchmarking is just one of the equations. The other equation is the cost of adopting it, the power cost of running the product. The media say, it came six months late, and it came very hungry. The question, is it really a solution that customers want to adopt?

Our "Evergreen" products were the industry's first DX11 products. In fact, today we still hold the 'Fastest